

Digital Marketing

Mod 5 - Case Study

Creating a Page for Your Business on Facebook

Theory

- A Facebook Page (as opposed to a personal profile) acts as your business's presence on Facebook. It allows to:
 - Present brand information (logo, cover image, "About" section, services/products)
 - Post updates, images, videos, links to engage your audience
 - Use Facebook's analytics, ad tools, and connection with other Facebook-features (Groups, Events)
- Key steps/considerations:
 - Choose a clear Page name consistent with your brand
 - Design a recognizable profile picture (brand logo) and a compelling cover image/banner
 - Fill out all "About" and contact info (address, phone, website, hours)
 - Define Page roles and access (Admins, Editors)
 - Set content strategy: voice/tone, post frequency, types of posts (images, videos, links)
 - Invite initial followers (existing customers, email list, website visitors)
- Benefits:
 - Builds brand presence on a major social network
 - Enables organic engagement (followers, shares, comments)
 - Serves as a foundation for advertising (boosting posts, target audiences)
 - Enables integration with Facebook tools: Groups, Events, Shops, etc.
- Challenges:
 - Gaining followers and making meaningful engagement (vs. just likes)
 - Creating content that resonates and stands out amid noise
 - Aligning with brand voice and avoiding inconsistent messaging
 - Ensuring you keep the page active (posting regularly)

Case Studies

Duolingo

- Duolingo created its social presence in a very content-first way. While much of its focus is broader than just Facebook (TikTok, Instagram, etc.), their Facebook presence is part of the ecosystem. For example: their "fun, trend-driven" social strategy is described in multiple analyses.
- Key lessons:
 - They treated their brand mascot (Duo the owl) not just as a logo but as a character that appears in posts, creating personality.
 - Their content is less about "we sell" and more about "we entertain / we engage" which makes their Page presence more than static brand information.
 - They made brand voice consistent across platforms, so the Facebook Page is integrated into a larger social identity.

Pepsi

- Pepsi has a long history of using Facebook (and other social platforms) for brand engagement. For example, a study shows that in India, Pepsi amplified its TV ads via Facebook video ads and social reach. Also, one specific case: PepsiCo tested cinemagraphs (a hybrid between photo/video) in Facebook ads. While that's more campaign/advertising than just the Page itself, it shows the brand is using the Facebook Page + feed + ads environment innovatively.
- Lessons:

- Being bold with visuals and formats (cinemagraphs rather than static images) can help your Facebook Page stand out.
- Leveraging Facebook as a companion channel to other media (TV, offline) helps unify brand presence.

Facing Facebook Groups

Theory

- A Facebook Group is a community space on Facebook where members can join, engage, share and discuss topics (versus a Page, which is brand-owned).
- For a business, “facing” or engaging with Facebook Groups means either creating your own brand-related Group or participating in relevant external Groups.
- Key considerations:
 - Purpose of the Group: support community, brand fans, product feedback, thought leadership.
 - Moderation: set rules, manage spam/trolls, encourage positive engagement.
 - Content strategy: encourage user-generated posts, discussion threads, Q&A, live sessions.
 - Integration with brand: occasionally share brand/content, but avoid being overly promotional (Groups thrive when members feel participation is authentic).
 - Metrics: membership growth, active posts, comments per post, engagement rate within Group.
- Benefits:
 - Builds deeper connection, loyalty, advocacy (members feel part of something)
 - Enables feedback, product ideas, brand evangelism
 - Social proof: members invite friends, share experiences
- Challenges:
 - Requires time/effort to moderate and engage.
 - If brand too promotional, members may disengage.
 - Measuring impact (linking Group activity to business KPIs) can be tougher.

Case Studies

Duolingo

- While I did not find a publicly prominent case of Duolingo creating a large Facebook Group (their social strategy is broader), we can infer how their approach would map onto a Group scenario:
 - Their content strategy emphasises authenticity and community (“Duo the owl,” trend-jacking, user engagements) which aligns well with a Group model where users feel part of a group culture.
 - For example, if Duolingo were to create a Facebook Group for learners of a language, they’d likely encourage user stories, share humorous content relating to their brand voice, enable peer support, etc.
- Learnings:
 - If you run a business Page, consider creating a Group for your most engaged audience or your fans to deepen relationships.
 - Use your brand voice (humour/relatability) within the Group to avoid being too corporate.

Pepsi

Pepsi’s focus has been more on large-scale campaigns and paid media rather than community Groups per se (at least in the public case studies I located). However:

- They did leverage Facebook’s interactive formats (for example cinemagraph ads) rather than simply static posts. That suggests a mindset of encouraging richer engagement — which could translate to Group strategy.
- From older studies: Pepsi had over 34 million Facebook fans at a point.

Hosting Facebook Events

Theory: Facebook Events are ways to organise and promote upcoming occasions via Facebook: online webinars, live sessions, in-person gatherings, product launches, etc.

- Key features:
 - Event Page: name, date/time, location (physical or virtual), description, cover photo, host, etc.
 - RSVP mechanism: people can mark “Going”, “Interested”, or “Not Going”.
 - Updates/Posts in Event discussion feed: share cast, agenda, reminders, live stream links.
 - Integration with Page: host the Event through your Page to leverage followers.
- Why use Events:
 - Creates a sense of occasion and urgency (date/time fixed).
 - Helps drive attendance and build hype.
 - Enables community interaction ahead of the event (discussion feed).
 - Can be used for lead generation (capture RSVPs) and follow-up.
- Best practices:
 - Provide clear value: what will attendees gain?
 - Use appealing visuals (cover image, posts)
 - Promote ahead of time (via Page posts, Groups, ads)
 - Send reminders (1 day before, 1 hour before)
 - During or post-event: engage with live content, follow-up messages, thank-you posts, next steps (offer, survey)
- Metrics to monitor:
 - Number of RSVPs (“Going” + “Interested”)
 - Actual attendance rate (if trackable)
 - Engagement during event feed (comments, questions)
 - Conversion or follow-up actions (downloads, sign-ups, purchases)

Case Studies

Pepsi

- Pepsi’s use of Facebook Events is more classic in the sense of product launches and brand experience events (offline and online). For example, campaigns like “Live for Now” (though more global than just Facebook) include social media integration.
- Specific mentions for Facebook: In India, Pepsi leveraged Facebook video and reach in footprint campaigns.
- Application:
 - Pepsi could create a Facebook Event for a new flavor launch, invite fans, live stream the launch, share exclusive giveaways, etc.
 - For your business: consider aligning your Event timing (holiday, product launch, new service) and use Facebook Event as a hub: invite → engage → follow-up.

Developing a Facebook Marketing Plan

Theory

A comprehensive Facebook marketing plan typically includes the following components:

1. Objectives – What you want to achieve via Facebook (brand awareness, engagement, leads, sales).
2. Audience target – Define demographics, interests, behaviours, lookalike audiences.
3. Content strategy – What types of posts (images, videos, stories, live), frequency, tone, themes.
4. Paid advertising strategy – Budget, bidding strategy, creatives, targeting, retargeting, custom audiences.
5. Integration with other channels – Website, email, Instagram, WhatsApp, offline.
6. Calendar and schedule – When to post, when to run campaigns, events, promotions.
7. Metrics and KPIs – Reach, impressions, engagement rate, click-through rate (CTR), conversion, cost per result.
8. Budget and resources – How much you will spend (organic + paid), tools, personnel.

9. Optimization and testing – A/B tests, creative iterations, budget adjustments, learnings cycle.
10. Compliance and brand guidelines – Tone/voice, legal disclosures, brand assets.

Case Studies

Duolingo

- Duolingo’s social media and Facebook-adjacent approach shows how they built a marketing plan emphasising organic community + viral content over heavy paid spend. For example:
 - They focused on entertainment over selling: “Our content is more about engaging and entertaining than push-selling language courses.”
 - They emphasised trend-hopping and authenticity (key part of content strategy) to align with their Gen-Z/younger audience.
 - They leveraged their mascot (Duo) as central creative anchor — giving a consistent theme across content.
 - On metrics: social reach soared (reported reach 900+ million for a period) for their broader social strategy.
 - Integration: While not strictly Facebook-only, their marketing plan integrated across platforms (TikTok, etc.) which helps feed into Facebook content.
- Application:
 - Your plan should potentially prioritise content that resonates (not just promotional).
 - Pick a “character” or consistent theme (like Duo) to keep posts recognisable.
 - Include testing of content formats (meme, video, live) and track which formats do better.
 - Even if budget is low, creativity and consistent posting can drive results.

Pepsi

- Pepsi’s marketing plan on Facebook and beyond shows more of a large-brand, omnichannel approach:
 - Creative experimentation: e.g., PepsiCo’s A/B test between still photo vs. cinemagraph on Facebook. The cinemagraph ad saw a 51× lift in engagement compared to still photo.
 - Integration: They used Facebook video ads in India to amplify TV ads (leveraging Facebook as companion channel) and used the “Facebook Reach Block” model.
 - Targeting: In Mexico, PepsiCo used Facebook Ads (Meta’s tools) with Pixel/custom audiences to reach men/women 18-65 with specific interests.
- Application:
 - In your plan, include segmentation and targeting (by age, interest, behaviour) just as Pepsi did.
 - Use A/B testing of creatives (format, visuals) to determine what works best.
 - Use Facebook not just in isolation but as part of a broader mix (e.g., website, offline, other channels).
 - Set ambitious but measurable metrics (e.g., “We aim to increase engagement by X%”, “CTR to website from Facebook posts/ad is Y%”).

Analyzing Facebook Metrics: This topic has four sub-topics you mentioned: Checking referrals, Monitoring comments, Measuring link effectiveness, Making the grade on a Facebook Grader.

Theory

a) Checking referrals from websites

- Facebook allows you to see how much traffic is coming to your website from your Facebook Page/ads. Use tools like Google Analytics (Referral traffic) or Facebook Insights.
- Key metrics: number of sessions from Facebook referral, bounce rate, pages per session, goal conversions from that traffic.
- Importance: Understand whether your Facebook activity is driving actual traffic and potentially conversions on your site.

b) Monitoring post comments

- Comments on your Page posts are an indicator of engagement. You should monitor:
 - Number of comments / post
 - Tone of comments (positive, negative, questions)
 - Response time (brand replies to comments)
 - Spark of discussion (comments responding to each other)
- Importance: High quality comments mean deeper engagement and stronger community. Moderation may be needed to manage spam/trolls.

c) Measuring link effectiveness

- When you post links (to blog, landing page, product page), you need to measure how well they perform:
 - Click-through rate (CTR): how many users clicked the link vs how many saw the post
 - Conversion rate after click (if you track)
 - Time on site/pages visited after link click
 - Cost per click or cost per conversion (if tied to ad spend)
- Tools: Facebook Insights for link posts, UTM parameters + Google Analytics, Facebook Ads Manager.

d) Making the grade on a “Facebook Grader”

- “Facebook Grader” is a term for tools or frameworks that evaluate how optimized a Facebook Page is (profile completeness, content strategy, engagement, responsiveness).
- Example criteria: completeness of Page info, post regularity, engagement rate, virality of posts, audience feedback, response rate.
- Importance: Helps benchmark performance, identify areas of improvement, and track over time.

Case Studies

Duolingo

- Checking referrals / link effectiveness: While specific numbers for Facebook are not published, Duolingo’s social strategy emphasises reaching large audiences, so for referrals the implication is they ensure their social posts link to app download pages, blogs, etc. Their overall social reach (~906 M) suggests large traffic potential.
- Monitoring comments/community: Duolingo’s engagement strategy leans heavily on comments, shares, user-generated memes (“Duo kidnaps your family if you don’t do your lesson” etc). They monitor what users are saying and lean into trends.
- Measuring link effectiveness: Their approach of entertainment rather than direct selling might mean link clicks are somewhat indirect (engagement first, then conversion). But they clearly use social metrics to guide what content works.
- Facebook Grader style: Although not explicitly named, Duolingo continuously tests content formats, adapts, and optimises for engagement — essentially “grading” their own social performance (e.g., they measure impressions, reach, mentions).
- Learning application:
 - On your Page, track how many users click from your posts (links) and what they do after.
 - Monitor comments for sentiment and community discussion not just volume.
 - Use internal review (every month) of your Page’s completeness, post frequency, engagement rate and set targets for improvement.

Pepsi

- Checking referrals: In the case of India, Pepsi used Facebook video ads to amplify TV, generating engagement and share of viewership (though exact referral traffic to website may not be public)
- Monitoring comments: Pepsi has experienced sentiment issues — for example a social media analysis found a spike in negative sentiment towards Pepsi on Facebook/Instagram, where 34% of conversation about Pepsi was generated by fake accounts.

- Measuring link effectiveness: Example: in U.S., PepsiCo's cinemagraph vs still image A/B test showed that the cinemagraph ad had a 0.47 % CTR vs 0.27% for still photo in that experiment.
- Facebook Grader concept: Pepsi's digital team treated these experiments as optimisations, so you can view this as them "grading" different ad formats and learning which format yields better results.
 - Learning application:
 - For your business, use A/B testing of links or ad formats on Facebook and measure CTR + conversions. Monitor sentiment in comments (positive vs negative) and address negative feedback.
 - Set up an internal grade or KPI dashboard: e.g., "Engagement rate must be >2% per post", "Link CTR >1%", "Response time to comments <1 hr".

Digital Marketing Through WhatsApp

Theory

- WhatsApp (owned by Meta) is a messaging platform that allows businesses to use dedicated tools (WhatsApp Business App or the WhatsApp Business Platform/API) to engage customers.
- Why include WhatsApp in your marketing mix:
 - Very high open and engagement rates (e.g., open rates 90-99%).
 - Customers already use WhatsApp massively; you're engaging where they are.
 - Enables personalised, conversational marketing / support (one-to-one or broadcast)
 - Rich media support: text, images, video, product catalogue, buttons/calls-to-action.
 - Integrates well with CRM, automation, bots (especially via API).
- Key steps to deploy:
 - Set up WhatsApp Business Account / WhatsApp Business Platform.
 - Collect opt-ins from customers (you must have permission to message them)
 - Segment your audience for targeting
 - Choose message templates (approved by WhatsApp)
 - Use entry points: click-to-WhatsApp links/ads, QR codes on packaging, website "Chat with us on WhatsApp".
 - Create flows: welcome message, abandoned cart reminder, order status update, promotional broadcast, loyalty offers.
- Metrics to track:
 - Delivered messages, read/open rate, response rate, click rate (if links), conversion rate (sale/lead)
 - Conversation length, time to reply (customer service)
 - ROI (cost per conversion)
- Best practices:
 - Keep messages short, personal, relevant
 - Use multimedia to engage (videos/images)
 - Avoid spamming — maintain frequency that customers accept
 - Ensure compliance with data/privacy rules
 - Use automation for scaling but keep human-touch where needed